

# NALINI BISHT

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PhD candidate in Immunology with 3 years of pharma R&D experience, 8 peer-reviewed publications, an international patent application, and award-winning scientific communication. Brings hypothesis-driven problem solving, rapid data synthesis, stakeholder communication, and life sciences expertise to complex healthcare, life sciences, and consulting challenges.

## EDUCATION

Baylor College of Medicine - PhD, Immunology & Microbiology

Expected Spring 2027

UIC College of Medicine at Rockford - MS, Medical Biotechnology

2016-2018

## EXPERIENCE

### Baylor College of Medicine - Researcher, Immunology

2021 – Present, Houston, TX

- Led a multi-year Immunology research project, translating an ambiguous biological question into experimental strategy, cross-platform analyses, and manuscript-ready conclusions; findings are being prepared for a first-author publication and support renewal of a \$400K NIH R01 research grant.
- Contributed significantly to a collaborative dendritic cell extracellular vesicle research program by supporting experimental design, data generation, analysis, and synthesis; work contributed to a co-first-author manuscript and an [international patent application](#).
- Led 2 CAR-T cell immunotherapy projects for pancreatic cancer treatment, requiring dose optimization across combination regimens; synthesized positive and negative findings to refine experimental strategy, leading to a first-author manuscript (pending).
- Led immune-response induction and characterization workstreams within collaborative parasitology and bladder cancer projects; contributed to cross-team analyses, including a [co-authored publication](#) from the parasitology project.
- Reviewed 50+ PhD applications as a Baylor admissions committee member; interviewed candidates and wrote structured evaluations to inform admit, waitlist, and reject decisions.
- Mentored high school and undergraduate trainees, coaching technical development, scientific communication, and presentation delivery; Mentoring a Rice University pre-med undergraduate for over 2 years, helping the trainee develop an award-winning poster presentation that earned second place among 50+ presenters at a Rice University-wide poster competition.
- Served as liaison between ~90 Immunology & Microbiology PhD students and the [Graduate Student Council](#) for 2 years, elevating student concerns to Baylor graduate school leadership, driving follow-through on council action items, and communicating decisions back to the program; chaired the career development committee for 1 year, supporting job fairs, webinars, and networking events.
- Conducted PhD-level Immunology instruction for 20 graduate students through office hours, exam review, and grading, translating complex immunology concepts into accessible instruction for diverse scientific audiences.

### Enanta Pharmaceuticals, Inc. - Associate Scientist, Biology

2018 – 2021, Boston, MA

- Conducted antiviral drug discovery across coronavirus (COVID-19) and respiratory syncytial virus (RSV) programs by developing cell-based assays, screening 500+ candidate drugs, and generating virology datasets used by cross-functional teams to prioritize drug candidates for pipeline development, including candidates that advanced to clinical trials for [COVID-19](#) and [RSV](#).
- Supported mechanism-of-action studies for RSV antiviral drug candidates by generating, sequencing, and profiling drug-resistant RSV-A/B strains, informing lead optimization within the company drug pipeline.
- Pioneered drug-resistance profiling for a COVID-19 antiviral candidate, generating data that supported US-FDA IND filing and subsequent publication in [Nature Communications](#); additionally synthesized resistance, quality control, and documentation data supporting RSV antiviral IND-enabling activities and manuscript development.
- Presented findings and recommendations during biweekly meetings across five cross-functional project teams, communicating experimental results, and next steps to support project decisions and workflow continuity.

### UIC College of Medicine at Rockford - Researcher

2016-2017, Rockford, IL

- Advanced immunomodulation research across colitis and type 1 diabetes mouse models, generating preclinical evidence that contributed to a [first-author peer-reviewed publication](#) in Biomedicines.
- Designed and taught molecular biology laboratory sessions and quantitative laboratory mathematics modules for 30+ master's students, supporting hands-on experimental training and exam preparation.

## INNOVATION & PUBLICATIONS

- Co-inventor, International Patent Application [PCT/US2024/028938](#), filed May 10, 2024: "Compositions Comprising and Methods of Using Dendritic Cell Exosomes."
- Author/co-author of 8 peer-reviewed publications across [immunology](#), [antiviral drug discovery](#), [parasitology](#), and [nanobiotechnology](#), including Nature Communications, Frontiers in Immunology, Biomedicines, and Nano-Structures & Nano-Objects.
- Presented research at AACR Advances in Pancreatic Cancer Research, AAI IMMUNOLOGY, FOCiS, and other scientific meetings.

## AWARDS & COMMUNICATION

- Awarded the Best Poster Presentation among 25 participants, Gulf Coast Consortia Future of Immunology Symposium (2026); First Place Best Oral Presentation among 40 participants, Baylor Pathology & Immunology Trainee Research Symposium (2025, 2026).
- Second Place Elevator Pitch Competition among 40+ participants, Baylor Graduate Student Symposium (2024); additional poster and lightning talk awards among 50+ participants from the 2025 Gulf Coast Consortia Future of Immunology Symposium.